# E Sum 3 Grammar notes

## Verb forms: the present tense

- The present tense is used to describe:
  - **What you are doing** *(I am eating)*
  - **What you normally do** *(I eat)*
  - **What you have been doing/have done for some time**
    *(I have been eating for…. I have eaten for…)*

- Only the context tells you whether *je mange* means *I eat* or *I am eating*. **Never attempt to say anything like** ~~*je suis mangeant*~~.

- Regular verbs follow the following pattern:

| | **passer** | *to pass* | | **choisir** | *to choose* | | **vendre** | *to sell* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *je* | *pass* | **e** | *je* | *chois* | **is** | *je* | *vend* | **s** |
| *tu* | *pass* | **es** | *tu* | *chois* | **is** | *tu* | *vend* | **s** |
| *il/elle* | *pass* | **e** | *il/elle* | *chois* | **it** | *il/elle* | *vend* | **-** |
| *nous* | *pass* | **ons** | *nous* | *chois* | **issons** | *nous* | *vend* | **ons** |
| *vous* | *pass* | **ez** | *vous* | *chois* | **issez** | *vous* | *vend* | **ez** |
| *ils/elles* | *pass* | **ent** | *ils/elles* | *chois* | **issent** | *ils/elles* | *vend* | **ent** |

- Verbs ending in -GER, -CER, -YER and -E/É-consonant-ER have stem changes in the present tense and these should be revised from F.

- Irregular -IR verbs should be revised
- Irregular -OIR verbs should be revised
- Irregular - RE verbs should be revised
- Irregular -IRE verbs should be revised

## Verb forms: the future tense

- The future tense is used to describe:
  - **What you will be doing** *(I will be eating)*
  - **What you will do** *(I will eat)*

- To form the future tense, simply:
  - Take the infinitive (removing the final E of –RE verbs) manger, finir, vendre
  - Add the correct personal ending: (rather like "AVOIR" in the present tense)

    je PARLER – **ai**
    tu FINIR – **as**
    il/elle VENDR – **a**
    nous RÉUSSIR – **ons**
    vous RENCONTRER – **ez**

ils RENDR – **ont**

- As usual, there are some frequently used **irregular stems** to learn:

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| *avoir* | **j'aur ai** | *vouloir* | **je voudr ai** |
| *aller* | **j'ir ai** | *mourir* | **je mourr ai** |
| *être* | **je ser ai** | *pouvoir* | **je pourr ai** |
| *voir* | **je verr ai** | *courir* | **je courr ai** |
| *envoyer* | **j'enverr ai** | *savoir* | **je saur ai** |
| *recevoir* | **je recevr ai** | *s'asseoir* | **je m'assiér ai** |
| *devoir* | **je devr ai** | *il faut* | **il faudr a** |
| *faire* | **je fer ai** | *il pleut* | **il pleuvr a** |
| *venir* | **je viendr ai** | | |
| *tenir* | **je tiendr ai** | | |

- The spelling changes which take place for *certain* persons in the present tense, take place for **ALL** persons in the future tense. See E Mich 3.

## Verb forms: the imperfect tense

- The imperfect tense is used to describe:
  - **What you were doing** *(I was eating)*
  - **What you normally did/used to do** *(I ate/I used to eat/I would eat)*
  - **What you had been doing/had done for some time**
    *(I had been eating for…. I had eaten for…)*

- To form the imperfect tense of any verb (except *ÊTRE* whose stem is *ÉT*), simply:
  - **Find the nous form of the present tense**
  - **Remove the –ONS ending** (nous choisiss~~ons~~, nous sav~~ons~~)
  - You are left with the "stem". **Add the personal ending to the stem**
    1. je CHOISISS – **ais**
    2. tu PARL – **ais**
    3. il/elle MANGE – **ait**
    4. nous SAV – **ions**
    5. vous ACHET – **iez**
    6. ils CONDUIS – **aient**
- See F Lent 7 for fuller details of when to use this tense.

## To play: jouer à or jouer de?

- When talking about musical instruments, use **DE**, for sports and games use **À**.

  - *De quels instruments sais-tu jouer? Et à quels sports sais-tu jouer?*
  - *Je joue du piano, de la trompette, au rugby et aux échecs.*
  - *Il joue au Monopoly et aux cartes pour passer le temps.*